

PSYCHIATRIC INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

*Complete Clinician's Reference — All Sections of Nitin Sethi Format | For each symptom ask: Present/Absent Onset
Duration Intensity (1-10) Frequency Course Impact*

1. IDENTIFICATION DATA

1. What is your full name?
2. How old are you? / Date of birth?
3. Gender?
4. Marital status? (Single/Married/Divorced/Widowed/Separated)
5. Religion / faith / community?
6. Language spoken at home?
7. Highest education completed?
8. Current occupation? Currently employed?
9. Socioeconomic status? (Upper/Middle/Lower)
10. Residence? (Urban/Semi-urban/Rural) Full address?
11. Who has come with you today? Relationship?
12. Who knows you best & can give information?

Informant Assessment

1. How long have you known the patient?
2. Do you live with them? How often do you see them?
3. How well do you know their daily routine?
4. Anything the patient might not share that's important?

2. CHIEF COMPLAINTS

Eliciting

1. What brought you here today? Main problem?
2. Tell me in your own words what's troubling you.
3. Main difficulties recently?
4. Anything else bothering you?
5. Single biggest problem right now?

Duration & Onset (for each complaint)

1. When did this start? How long?
2. Sudden or gradual onset?
3. Exact date/week you first noticed?
4. Anything happening in life when it started?
5. Getting worse/same/better since?
6. Present all the time or comes & goes?

Intensity (for each)

1. Scale 1-10, how severe?
2. How much does it interfere with daily life?
3. Stop you from doing normal things? What?
4. Affected work/studies/household?
5. Affected relationships?
6. Affected sleep/appetite/self-care?

From Informant

1. What changes have you noticed?
2. Main problem noticed? When first?
3. Anything patient hasn't mentioned?
4. What concerns you most right now?

3. HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS (HOPI)

Onset & Precipitating Factors

1. When exactly did current episode start?
2. Sudden (days) or gradual (weeks/months)?
3. What was happening in life at that time?
4. Stressful event? (Financial/relationship/job/bereavement/conflict/illness)
5. Physically unwell before symptoms? Fever/head injury/seizures?
6. New medications/drugs/substances around that time?
7. Recently stopped any medications/substances?
8. Change in living situation/routine?

Framework for EACH Symptom

First: Present or Absent? If present, ask all below:

1. Onset: When first appeared? Sudden/gradual?
2. Duration: How long? Constant/intermittent?
3. Frequency: How often? (Daily/several times/weekly?)
4. Intensity: Scale 1-10? Worst it gets?
5. Course: Getting worse/better/same?
6. Aggravating: What makes it worse?
7. Relieving: What makes it better?
8. Associated symptoms: Anything else at same time?
9. Impact: Effect on work/relationships/self-care?

Depressed Mood

1. Feeling sad/low/down? (P/A)
2. How long? (Duration)
3. All day or comes & goes?
4. Scale 1-10 at worst? (Intensity)
5. Worse at particular time of day? (Diurnal variation)
6. Feel like crying? Actually cry? How often?
7. Feel hopeless?
8. Feel worthless/burden to others?
9. Feel guilty? About what?
10. Lost interest in enjoyable things? (Anhedonia P/A)
11. Activities stopped doing?

Elevated Mood

1. Unusually happy/elated/on top of world? (P/A)
2. How long? (Duration)
3. Others notice? What do they say?
4. Feel special powers/abilities/importance?
5. Need less sleep but energetic?
6. More talkative than usual?

7. Spending more/impulsive decisions?
8. Thoughts racing?
9. Starting many new projects?
10. Caused problems? (Work/family/finances)

Irritability

1. More irritable/short-tempered? (P/A)
2. How long? (Duration)
3. Small things make you very angry? (Intensity)
4. Lose temper easily? How often?
5. Shouted at/threatened/hit anyone?
6. What triggers it?
7. Can you control it?

Anxiety

1. Feeling anxious/nervous/worried? (P/A)
2. How long? (Duration)
3. Mild unease or severe panic? (Intensity 1-10)
4. About something specific or general?
5. Sudden episodes of intense fear? (Panic attacks P/A)
6. If panic: How often? How long? Symptoms? (Palpitations/sweating/trembling/breathlessness/chest pain/dizziness)
7. Avoid places/situations because of anxiety? Which?
8. Specific fears/phobias? (Heights/closed spaces/crowds/social)
9. Excessive worry about many things? Can you control it?
10. Physical symptoms? (Trembling/sweating/palpitations/dry mouth/nausea)

3. HOPI (cont.) — Thought & Perception

Delusions

1. People against you/trying to harm? (Persecution P/A)
2. People talking about/referring to you? (Reference P/A)
3. Special powers/wealth/mission? (Grandiosity P/A)
4. Committed great sin/terrible wrong? (Guilt P/A)
5. Body rotting/diseased/infested? (Somatic P/A)
6. Partner unfaithful? Evidence? (Jealousy P/A)
7. Someone in love with you? (Erotomania P/A)
8. You/world don't exist? (Nihilistic P/A)
9. Someone controlling thoughts/actions? (Control P/A)
10. For each present: When start? (Onset)
11. How strongly believe? 100% certain? (Conviction)
12. Possibility you could be wrong?
13. How affects behavior? Done what because of it?
14. Interconnected with other beliefs? (Systematization)

Hallucinations

1. Hear voices/sounds others can't? (Auditory P/A)
2. If yes: How many? Male/female? Familiar?
3. Talk to you (2nd person) or about you (3rd)?
4. Command you? Obeyed?
5. Comment on actions? (Running commentary)
6. Inside head or outside?

7. How often? (Frequency) How long each time? (Duration)
8. How loud? Can you ignore? (Intensity)
9. When first started? (Onset) Getting more/less frequent? (Course)
10. See things others can't? (Visual P/A) What? Formed/vague? Day/night?
11. Smell things others can't? (Olfactory P/A)
12. Feel things on skin not there? (Tactile P/A)
13. Taste things not there? (Gustatory P/A)

Thought Possession

1. Thoughts being put in by someone else? (Insertion P/A)
2. Thoughts being taken away? (Withdrawal P/A)
3. Others can hear/know your thoughts? (Broadcasting P/A)
4. Hear own thoughts aloud? (Echo P/A)
5. For each: When start? How often? How distressing?

Obsessions & Compulsions

1. Repetitive unwanted thoughts? (Obsessions P/A)
2. If yes: About what? (Contamination/doubt/harm/symmetry/religious/sexual)
3. How often? (Frequency) How distressing 1-10? (Intensity)
4. Can resist/stop? What happens if try?
5. Recognize as own? Know irrational?
6. Compelled to repeat actions? (Compulsions P/A)
7. If yes: What? (Washing/checking/counting/arranging)
8. How many times? Time daily? (Duration)
9. What if try to resist? (Anxiety increases?)
10. Know excessive/unreasonable?
11. How long having these? (Duration of illness)

3. HOPI (cont.) — Biological Functions

Sleep

1. Change in sleep? (P/A)
2. Time to bed? Time fall asleep? How long to fall asleep? (Initial insomnia)
3. Wake middle of night? Times? Go back to sleep? (Middle insomnia)
4. Wake very early, can't go back? Time? (Terminal insomnia)
5. Total hours/night?
6. Sleep excessively >10-12h? (Hypersomnia P/A)
7. Feel rested or still tired?
8. Nightmares? How often?
9. How long disturbed? (Duration) How severe? (Intensity)
10. Sleep before illness? (Baseline)

Appetite & Weight

1. Appetite changed? (Increased/Decreased/Same)
2. Meals/day? Compare to before?
3. Force to eat / no desire? OR eating much more?
4. Weight gain/loss? How much? Over what period?
5. How long affected? (Duration)

Energy & Fatigue

1. Tired/fatigued? (P/A)
2. Mild or completely exhausted? (Intensity)

3. From morning or develops through day?
4. Affected daily tasks?
5. How long? (Duration)

Libido

1. Change in sexual desire? (Increased/Decreased/Absent)
2. How long? (Duration)
3. Caused relationship problems?

Psychomotor Changes

1. Feel slowed down? (Retardation P/A)
2. Feel restless/can't sit still? (Agitation P/A)
3. Others noticed?
4. How long? (Duration) How severe? (Intensity)

Diurnal Variation

1. Time of day feel worse? Morning/evening?
2. Symptoms change through day in pattern?

3. HOPI (cont.) — Cognitive & Behavioral

Cognitive

1. Difficulty concentrating? (P/A)
2. Can read article/watch TV without mind wandering?
3. Memory problems? (P/A) Forget recent events? Old memories?
4. Confused/disoriented?
5. Difficulty making decisions?
6. How long? (Duration) How severe? (Intensity) Getting worse? (Course)

Aggression & Violence

1. Aggressive/violent toward anyone? (P/A)
2. Verbal or physical?
3. How often? (Frequency) Triggers?
4. Injured anyone? Arrested?
5. Feel remorse after?

Self-Harm & Suicidal Behavior (ALWAYS ASK)

1. Felt life not worth living? (P/A)
2. Wished you were dead/not wake up?
3. Thoughts of harming self/ending life? (Suicidal ideation P/A)
4. If yes: How often? (Freq) How strong? (Intensity) How long? (Duration)
5. Thought about how? Have a plan?
6. Made preparations? (Pills/note/given belongings)
7. What has stopped you?
8. Past attempts? (P/A) When? Method? Intent? Planned/impulsive?
9. Self-harm without intent to die? (Cutting/burning P/A) What/how often/triggers?
10. Thoughts of harming others? (Homicidal P/A) Toward whom? Plan?

Social Withdrawal

1. Withdrawing from family/friends/activities? (P/A)
2. How long? (Duration) Stay in room? Avoid people?
3. Don't feel like it OR afraid of something?

Decreased Self-Care

1. Neglecting hygiene? (Bathing/grooming/clothes P/A)
2. How long? (Duration) Able to cook/clean/manage routine?

Bizarre Behavior

1. Done anything others found strange? (P/A)
2. Talking to self? Laughing/crying without reason?
3. Collecting things/wandering/removing clothes? How long?

Course & Treatment

1. Continuous or episodic? If episodic: how many? Duration each? Recovery between?
2. Getting worse/stable/improving?
3. Treatment for current episode? Medications (name/dose/duration/response)?
4. Side effects? Currently on meds? Taking regularly?
5. ECT? Hospitalized? Why come now?

Functional Impact

1. Affected work/study? Relationships? Self-care? Finances? Family role? Household?
2. Percentage of normal functioning now?

4. PAST PSYCHIATRIC HISTORY

Previous Episodes

1. Similar problems in past? (P/A) How many episodes?
2. For each: When? Symptoms (similar/different)? Duration? Severity?
3. For each: Diagnosis? Treatment (meds/doses/therapy/ECT)? Response?
4. For each: Hospitalized? Where? How long?
5. For each: Recovered completely between? Precipitating factor?
6. Longest well period? Shortest gap? Getting worse over time?

Past Suicidal Behavior

1. Ever attempted suicide? (P/A) How many times?
2. For each: When? Method? Intent (want to die)? Planned/impulsive?
3. For each: How rescued? Hospitalized? Treatment?
4. For each: Circumstances? How feel about it now?

Treatment Adherence

1. Ever stopped meds on your own? Why?
2. Stopped because felt better?
3. Stopped because side effects? Which?
4. Missed appointments? Why?
5. Overall attitude toward psychiatric treatment?

5. PAST MEDICAL & SURGICAL HISTORY

Medical Illnesses (Ask each: P/A)

1. Diabetes? Hypertension? Thyroid?
2. Epilepsy/seizures? Head injury/unconsciousness?
3. Stroke? Heart disease? Asthma/lung disease?
4. Liver/kidney disease? HIV? Hepatitis B/C?
5. Autoimmune disease? Neurological conditions (Parkinson's/MS/dementia)?
6. Any other? For each present: When diagnosed? Treatment? Controlled?

Surgical History

1. Any surgeries? (P/A) What? When? Complications?
2. Brain/nervous system surgery?
3. Psychiatric symptoms after any surgery?

Current Medications

1. Current physical health medications? Name/dose/frequency/duration for each.
2. Steroids/beta-blockers/anti-epileptics/hormonal meds?
3. Mental changes since starting any medication?

Drug Allergies

1. Allergic to any medications? (P/A) Which? What reaction?
2. Severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis)?

6. SUBSTANCE USE HISTORY

Screening (each substance: P/A)

1. Tobacco (smoking/chewing/gutka/snuff)?
2. Alcohol?
3. Cannabis (marijuana/ganja/bhang/charas)?
4. Opioids (heroin/opium/morphine/tramadol)?
5. Sedatives (benzodiazepines without Rx)?
6. Stimulants (amphetamines/cocaine/meth)?
7. Inhalants (glue/petrol/whitener/thinner)?
8. Any other substances?

For EACH Substance Present — Initiation & Pattern

1. Age first tried? Circumstances (peers/curiosity/stress)?
2. How use progressed?
3. Current pattern (daily/weekends/binge/occasional)?
4. Amount per day/session? Route (oral/smoking/IV/snorting)?
5. Last use?

Duration & Escalation

1. How long using regularly? (Duration)
2. Amount increased over time?
3. Need more for same effect? (Tolerance P/A)

Dependence Features

1. Strong craving? (P/A)
2. Difficulty controlling use? (Impaired control P/A)
3. Withdrawal symptoms when stop/reduce? (P/A) What symptoms?
4. Neglected work/family/hobbies? (P/A)
5. Continue despite known harm? (P/A)
6. Most important thing in life? (Salience P/A)
7. Narrowed variety of substances? (P/A)

Complications

1. Physical problems? (Liver/gastritis/neuropathy/lung/HIV risk)
2. Psychiatric problems? (Depression/psychosis/anxiety/memory)
3. Social problems? (Family/divorce/job loss/legal/accidents)
4. Financial problems?

5. Previous treatment? Tried to quit? Times? Longest abstinent?
6. Current motivation to quit?

7. FAMILY HISTORY

Composition & Structure

1. Nuclear or joint/extended family? How many members?
2. Each member: age, education, occupation, health?
3. Parents alive? If deceased: cause/when?
4. Siblings: ages, occupations? Parents together/separated?
5. Primary earner? Financial status?

Psychiatric & Medical Illness in Family (each: P/A)

1. Anyone had mental health problems? Who?
2. Depression/mood problems? Psychosis? Anxiety/panic?
3. Substance use? Suicide/attempted suicide?
4. Intellectual disability? Epilepsy? Dementia?
5. Hospitalized for mental health? Who/where/treatment?
6. For each: Diagnosis? Treatment? Outcome?
7. Other mental/neurological illness in family?

Family Dynamics

1. Atmosphere? (Warm/cold/conflictual/supportive)
2. Relationship with father? Mother? Siblings? Spouse?
3. Frequent conflict? About what?
4. Domestic violence? (Physical/emotional/sexual P/A)
5. Closest to whom? Go to whom for support?
6. Family understand illness? Supportive?
7. How has illness affected family?
8. High expressed emotion? (Criticism/hostility/over-involvement)

8. PERSONAL HISTORY

Birth & Early Development

1. Planned/wanted pregnancy? (Ask informant)
2. Complications during pregnancy? (P/A) (Infections/toxemia/substance use)
3. Full term or premature? Normal or cesarean delivery?
4. Birth complications? (Prolonged labor/instruments/asphyxia P/A)
5. Cried immediately? (Birth cry P/A) Birth weight normal?
6. Incubator/NICU? (P/A) Breastfed/bottle-fed? How long?

Developmental Milestones

1. Milestones at normal age? (Normal/Delayed)
2. Sit/crawl/stand/walk — when? (Motor: normal/delayed)
3. First words/sentences — when? (Language: normal/delayed)
4. Toilet trained when? Difficulties? (Normal/Delayed)
5. Any concerns about development?
6. Childhood illnesses? (Measles/meningitis/seizures/head injury P/A)

Childhood Behavioral Problems (each: P/A)

1. Thumb sucking/nail biting? Until what age?
2. Bed wetting (enuresis)? Until what age?

3. Temper tantrums? Severity? Frequency?
4. Night terrors/nightmares?
5. Separation anxiety/school refusal?
6. Hyperactive? Attention problems?
7. Loner or had friends? Bullied? Bully others?
8. Physical/emotional/sexual abuse? (P/A)

Educational History

1. Schools attended? How far studied?
2. Academic performance? (Above avg/avg/below avg)
3. Failed/repeated year? (P/A) Learning difficulties? (P/A)
4. Got along with classmates/teachers?
5. Extracurricular activities?
6. Disciplinary problems? (Truancy/fights/suspensions P/A)
7. Why stopped studying? Mental health affected education? (P/A)

Occupational History

1. Jobs held from first to current?
2. For each: Role? Duration? Why left? (Fired/resigned/illness)
3. For each: Got along with colleagues/supervisors?
4. Difficulty keeping job? (P/A) Why?
5. Current status? (Employed/Unemployed/Unable)
6. Work-related stressors? Financial situation? Debts?
7. Illness affected work? (P/A) How?

Sexual & Marital History

1. How learned about sex? Age of puberty?
2. Sexual orientation?
3. Romantic relationships before marriage? (P/A)
4. Sexual abuse/trauma? (P/A)
5. Married? Age? Arranged/love? Had choice?
6. Relationship with spouse? (Good/Fair/Poor/Conflictual)
7. Frequent arguments? About what? Domestic violence? (P/A)
8. Satisfied? Infidelity? (P/A) Separation/divorce? (P/A)
9. Children? How many? Ages? Relationship?
10. Sexual problems? (P/A) What? Duration? Related to illness?

Menstrual & Reproductive (Females)

1. Menarche age? Regular/irregular? Cycle length? Heavy/painful?
2. LMP? Could be pregnant? Menopause age?
3. Pregnancies (Gravida)? Deliveries (Parity)? Normal/cesarean?
4. Miscarriages/abortions? (P/A)
5. Psychiatric symptoms during/after pregnancy? (Postpartum P/A)
6. Contraception? Premenstrual mood changes? (PMS P/A)

Legal History

1. Trouble with law? (P/A) Arrested? For what?
2. Prison/jail? (P/A) How long?
3. Pending legal cases? (P/A)
4. Psychiatric condition related to legal issues?

9. PREMORBID PERSONALITY

Ask: "Before this illness, how were you as a person?" Also ask informant.

Temperament

1. Cheerful/happy or serious/gloomy?
2. Outgoing (extroverted) or quiet/reserved (introverted)?
3. Prefer people or alone?
4. Optimistic or pessimistic?
5. Calm/relaxed or anxious/tense?
6. Energetic or low-energy?
7. Typical reaction to stress? Coping style?

Interpersonal

1. How many close friends?
2. Deep/lasting or superficial friendships?
3. Trust easily or suspicious/guarded?
4. Easy/difficult to get along with?
5. Socially confident or shy?
6. Enjoy social gatherings or avoid?
7. Relationships with authority? (Respectful/rebellious/submissive)

Interests & Hobbies

1. Hobbies before illness?
2. Clubs/organizations/community activities?
3. Sports/reading/music/arts?
4. How spent free time?

Moral & Religious

1. How religious? Religion important?
2. Strict or flexible about rules/morals?
3. Rigid or open to viewpoints?
4. Beliefs changed since illness?

Mood Patterns

1. Usual mood before illness? (Happy/sad/anxious/irritable/stable)
2. Mood fluctuate or stable?
3. Handle frustration? Get angry easily?
4. React to disappointment/failure?
5. Emotional/sensitive or logical/rational?
6. Handle stress — cope well or break down?

Character Traits

1. Responsible/reliable?
2. Self-confident or self-doubting?
3. Independent or dependent?
4. Impulsive or careful/planned?
5. Perfectionist? Orderly/organized?
6. Stubborn or flexible?
7. Risk-taker or cautious?
8. Quick decisions or much deliberation?
9. Truthful/honest or manipulative?

10. Generous or stingy?
11. Eating/sleeping habits before illness?

10. MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

General Appearance & Behavior (OBSERVE)

1. Build? (Thin/average/obese) Looks stated age/older/younger?
2. Hygiene/grooming? (Clean/unkempt/malodorous)
3. Dress? (Appropriate/bizarre/disheveled)
4. Visible injuries/self-harm scars? Nourishment?
5. Sitting still or restless/agitated? (Psychomotor)
6. Moving slowly? (Retardation) Abnormal movements? (Tremors/tics/stereotypies)
7. Pacing/fidgeting/wringing hands?
8. Catatonic features? (Waxy flexibility/posturing/negativism/mutism)
9. Gait? (Normal/shuffling/unsteady)
10. Attitude? (Cooperative/hostile/guarded/suspicious/evasive/indifferent)
11. Eye contact? (Normal/fleeting/avoidant/staring)
12. Rapport? (Easy/difficult/not established)
13. Answering willingly/fully or evasive?

Speech (OBSERVE)

1. Rate? (Normal/increased-pressure/decreased-poverty/mute)
2. Volume? (Normal/loud/soft-whispered)
3. Tone? (Normal/monotonous/high-pitched)
4. Fluency? (Fluent/hesitant/stuttering/dysarthric)
5. Spontaneous or only in response to questions?
6. Relevant/goal-directed or irrelevant/rambling?
7. Coherent? Neologisms? Echolalia? Mutism?

Mood (ASK) & Affect (OBSERVE)

Mood (Subjective)

1. How are you feeling right now?
2. Describe your mood in one word?
3. Scale 1-10 (1=worst ever, 10=best)?
4. Same past few days or changes?

Affect (Observe)

1. Predominant: euthymic/depressed/elated/anxious/irritable/flat/blunted?
2. Range: full/restricted/blunted/flat?
3. Reactive: changes with topics?
4. Congruent with mood/content? (Smiling while describing sadness = incongruent)
5. Labile: changing rapidly? Appropriate to context?

Thought — Form (OBSERVE)

1. Goal-directed/logical? (Normal)
2. Flight of ideas? (P/A) Loosening of associations? (P/A)
3. Tangentiality? (P/A) Circumstantiality? (P/A)
4. Thought blocking? (P/A) Perseveration? (P/A)
5. Neologisms? (P/A) Word salad? (P/A) Clang associations? (P/A)
6. Amount: increased (pressure) or decreased (poverty)?

Thought — Content (ASK DIRECTLY)

Delusions

1. Beliefs others find unusual?
2. Anyone trying to harm/follow/plot against you? (Persecution P/A)
3. People referring to you on TV/radio/public? (Reference P/A)
4. Special powers/wealth/mission from God? (Grandiosity P/A)
5. Done something terrible/great sin? (Guilt P/A)
6. Body rotting/infested/not working? (Somatic P/A)
7. Spouse unfaithful? Evidence? (Jealousy P/A)
8. Everything hopeless/you don't exist? (Nihilistic P/A)
9. External forces controlling thoughts/feelings/actions? (Control P/A)
10. For each: Conviction? Onset? Effect on behavior?

Other Content

1. Repetitive thoughts you can't stop? (Obsessions P/A) About what? Own thoughts? Irrational?
2. Extreme fear of specific thing? (Phobias P/A) What? Avoid?
3. Thoughts of harming self/ending life right now? (Suicidal P/A) How strong?
4. Thoughts of harming others right now? (Homicidal P/A)
5. Idea occupying mind excessively? (Overvalued ideas P/A) See others' viewpoint?

Thought — Possession (ASK)

1. Thoughts put in from outside? (Insertion P/A)
2. Thoughts taken away? (Withdrawal P/A)
3. Others can hear/know your thoughts? (Broadcasting P/A)
4. Hear own thoughts aloud? (Echo P/A)

Perception (ASK EACH MODALITY)

1. Hear voices/sounds nobody else can? (Auditory P/A)
2. If yes: How many? Male/female? Familiar? 2nd/3rd person?
3. Commands? Running commentary? Inside head/outside?
4. Loud/whispered/shouting? (Intensity) How often? (Freq) How long each? (Duration)
5. When started? (Onset) More/less frequent? (Course) Distressing?
6. See things others can't? (Visual P/A) What? Formed/vague? Day/night?
7. Feel things on skin? (Tactile P/A)
8. Smell things? (Olfactory P/A) Taste things? (Gustatory P/A)
9. Things look distorted? (Illusions P/A)
10. Feel you are unreal/detached? (Depersonalization P/A)
11. World around unreal/like dream? (Derealization P/A)
12. If any present: How often? How long? How distressing?

10. MSE (cont.) — Cognition, Judgment, Insight

Consciousness & Orientation

1. Alert/drowsy/confused? (Observe consciousness)
2. Today's date? Day? Month? Year? (Time orientation)
3. Where are we? This place? City? Floor? (Place)
4. Your name? Who am I? Person with you? (Person)

Attention & Concentration

1. Count backwards 20 to 1?

2. Serial 7s from 100? (100, 93, 86, 79...)
3. Spell WORLD backwards?
4. Days of week backwards?
5. Digit span forward (5-8-2, 6-9-4-7) & backward (2-4, 6-2-9)?

Memory

1. Remember 3 words: "Apple, Table, Penny." Repeat now. (Immediate)
2. After 5 min: 3 words? (Recent)
3. Breakfast today? Yesterday? (Recent)
4. Birthday? Year married? School? (Remote)
5. Current PM/President? Before them? Recent news?

Intelligence (Clinical)

1. Education/academic background?
2. General knowledge? (States in India/capitals)
3. Simple arithmetic? (18 books give half = ? / Rs.100 - Rs.80 = ?)

Abstract Thinking

1. Proverbs: "A stitch in time saves nine"? "Glass houses shouldn't throw stones"? "Don't cry over spilt milk"?
2. Similarities: Apple & orange? Table & chair? Poem & statue?
3. Differences: Lie vs mistake? Child vs dwarf?

Judgment

1. Found stamped envelope on road — what do? Crowded cinema + fire? Stranger asks keep bag?
2. Manage money independently?
3. Making important decisions currently? Reasonable?
4. Think you are ill? Cause? Need treatment? Plans realistic?

Insight (Grade 1-6)

1. Anything wrong with you? (G1 if complete denial)
2. Something might be wrong but not sure? (G2)
3. Wrong but caused by others/external, not illness? (G3)
4. Something wrong but don't know what? (G4)
5. Think you have mental illness? Understand what? (G5)
6. Understand cause/what maintains/what to do? (G6)
7. Need treatment? Take meds regularly? What if don't treat?
8. Symptoms part of illness or real/normal?

11. DIAGNOSIS & FORMULATION

Diagnostic Clarification

1. Meet criteria for specific ICD-10/DSM-5 diagnosis?
2. Better explained by medical condition/substance?
3. Duration sufficient for criteria?
4. Significant distress/functional impairment?
5. Symptoms of more than one disorder? (Comorbidity)
6. Differential diagnoses to consider?

4 P's Formulation

Predisposing

1. Family history (genetic)? Developmental problems/childhood adversity?
2. Personality traits? Early attachment difficulties?

Precipitating

1. What triggered? (Life events/stressors/losses)
2. Medical illness/substance/medication change?
3. Relationship breakdown/bereavement/financial crisis?

Perpetuating

1. Ongoing stressors? Poor support? Non-adherence?
2. Negative thinking/avoidance? Ongoing substance use?
3. Family: high expressed emotion/enabling?

Protective

1. Strengths? (Intelligence/insight/motivation)
2. Good social support?
3. Previous good treatment response?
4. Coping skills/faith/resources?

12. TREATMENT PLAN

Treatment History & Preferences

1. Previous treatment? What worked/didn't?
2. Willing to take medications? Concerns?
3. Bad experiences/side effects in past?
4. Open to counseling/therapy? Had before?
5. Expectations from treatment?
6. Treatments you'd refuse? (ECT/hospitalization/specific meds)
7. Access to follow-up? Can come regularly?
8. Afford medications? Financial constraints?
9. Who at home can supervise medications?

Risk Assessment

1. Feel safe right now? Immediate danger?
2. Access to means? (Meds/sharp objects/pesticides/firearms)
3. Someone to stay with you for safety?
4. Safety plan: what will you do if feel like harming self?
5. Willing to come to emergency if unsafe?
6. Can I speak with family about safety?

Investigations

1. Recent blood tests? (CBC/LFT/KFT/Thyroid/Sugar)
2. Brain imaging? (CT/MRI if indicated)
3. EEG? (If seizures suspected)
4. Psychological testing? (IQ/personality/neuropsych)
5. Medical investigations pending?

Closing

1. Anything else to tell me I haven't asked?
2. Anything worried about we haven't discussed?
3. Questions for me?
4. Comfortable with the plan?
5. Emergency contact? Phone number?